and yet differences arose which were not present, or were present in far lesser degree, in the feudal and semi-feudal classes and the masses. The Hindu and Moslem masses were hardly distinguishable from each other, the old aristocracy had developed common ways and standards. They yet followed a common culture and had common custom and festivals. The middle classes began to diverge psychologically and later in other ways.

To begin with, the new middle classes were almost absent among the Moslems. Their avoidance of western education, their keeping away from trade and industry, and their adherence to feudal ways, gave a start to the Hindus which they profited by and retained. British policy was inclined to be pro-Hindu and anti-Moslem, except in the Punjab, where Moslems took more easily to western education than elsewhere. But the Hindus had got a big start long before the British took possession of the Punjab. Even in the Punjab, though conditions were more equal for the Hindu and Moslem, the Hindus had an economic advantage. Anti-foreign sentiment was shared alike by the Hindu and Moslem aristocracy and the masses. The Revolt of 1857 was a joint affair, but in its suppression Moslems felt strongly, and to